

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026 · GROUP H · MATCH 66 · MATCHDAY 3

Uruguay vs Spain

Friday, June 26, 2026 · Kickoff 8:00 PM ET / 6:00 PM CST / 8:00 AM MYT (Jun 27) · Estadio Akron, Zapopan, Jalisco, Mexico. Pre-match analysis for entertainment purposes only — not investment advice.

URU

Uruguay

FIFA #18 live · 2 pts ·
GD 0 · Need result

VS

Spain

FIFA #3 live · 4 pts · GD
+4 · Draw seals group

ESP

Report updated: June 26, 2026. Exchange rate basis: ECB reference **1 EUR = 1.08 USD** (June 23, 2026). DraftKings/FanDuel odds verified as of June 22–25, 2026. Starting XIs, score paths, and betting allocations are **Assumed/Inference** unless officially confirmed. Confirm all prices and lines at your sportsbook before wagering.

Key Conclusions

Spain Favored

~64% de-vigged win probability. Market prices La Roja -194 to -210 across major US books.

Central Score Path

Spain 2-0. Two clean sheets in group play; Uruguay missing Araujo & De Arrascaeta.

BTTS Lean: No

Uruguay under 0.5 team goals +102. Bielsa attack depleted; Spain defense unbeaten.

Group H Finale

Spain top with draw; Uruguay need ≥ 1 pt and Cape Verde result to advance safely.

Verified: Fixture, Venue, Referee Elfath

Verified: Group H Standings MD1-2

Verified: DraftKings/FanDuel Odds

Verified: Araujo, De Arrascaeta OUT; Pedri SUSP

Assumed: Predicted Lineups & Score Thesis

Assumed: Player Market Values (EUR→USD)

Concentrated Betting Plan

Budget: \$100 entertainment cap · **\$2 per unit** · 50 units total. Score thesis: Spain control possession through Rodri/Olmo, stretch Uruguay's high press with Yamal/Williams wide; depleted Uruguay attack struggles to break Spain's clean-sheet run. Evening rain risk narrows tempo but favors Spain's technical superiority.

⚠ **Concentrated plans increase variance and may lose the entire entertainment budget.**

Score Thesis Summary

Market baseline: Spain win ~64% de-vigged (DK -194 / FD -210). Total 2.5 — Over slightly favored (-108 DK). Spain unbeaten and unscored-against in group (0-0 Cape Verde, 4-0 Saudi Arabia). Uruguay drew 1-1 Saudi Arabia and 2-2 Cape Verde without Araujo or De Arrascaeta. Pedri suspended for Spain — Fabian Ruiz/Olmo expected to partner Rodri. **Central path: Spain 2-0.** Alternative: Spain 2-1 if Uruguay counter via Valverde/Núñez on wet pitch errors. Rain forecast (57–78% night) slightly suppresses total goals but Spain's set-piece quality (Oyarzabal, Yamal) remains threat.

\$70

Core — Spain Win to Nil (SGP) @ ~+140

35 units · Thesis: Spain defense +0 GA in 180 mins; Uruguay missing creative spine and top CB.

Min odds: +130 · **Cancel if:** Giménez returns to peak fitness and Núñez confirmed 100% starter with De La Cruz in XI.

35 u

\$20

Adjacent — Correct Score Spain 2-0 @ ~+450

10 units · Matches central path; Oyarzabal/Yamal scoring form vs depleted Uruguay back line.

Min odds: +400 · **Cancel if:** Heavy rain forces Spain to rotate Yamal/Williams or handicap line drops to -0.5.

10 u

Differential — Mikel Oyarzabal Anytime Goal @ ~+160

5 units · 2 goals in last start; penalty taker; Spain should dominate box entries.

\$10



5 u

Min odds: +150 · **Cancel if:** Oyarzabal rested or Spain shift to false-nine Olmo system.

Parlay Options (Higher Variance)

Combo	Legs	Est. Combined	Correlation Risk
Same-game	Spain Win to Nil + Under 3.5	~+200	High — both need controlled 1-0 or 2-0
Score parlay	Spain 2-0 + Oyarzabal scorer	~+900	Very high — correlated goal paths

Drop parlay legs if Spain rest Rodri or Uruguay start De La Cruz + Núñez together. Parlays carry higher variance than singles.

Pre-Purchase Check

Condition	Action
Handicap line moves to Spain -0.5	Market sees closer game; reduce win-to-nil core, consider Uruguay +0.5 at +160.
Pedri unexpectedly cleared to play	Reassess — Spain attack uplift may support -1.5 instead of win-to-nil.
Heavy rain at kickoff (>70%)	Halve correct-score allocation; wet pitch favors low-scoring grind.
Odds below stated minimums	Do not force — mark selection Not recommended.

Referee & Environment Impact

Referee: Ismail Elfath (USA)

Verified: FIFA-appointed referee for Match 66. Second WC26 assignment after Netherlands 2-2 Japan (Jun 14). Assistants: Corey Parker, Kyle Atkins (USA); 4th official Juan Calderón (CRC).

Assumed/Inference: Controlled officiating in high-intensity NED-JPN match; moderate card rate. Unlikely to disrupt Spain's rhythm.

Score adjustment: NO CHANGE on central path.

Match Environment

Venue: Estadio Akron, Zapopan — 45,364 capacity, open-air natural grass, ~1,500 m altitude.

Weather (Jun 26, 6:00 PM CST kickoff): Telediario/Infobae forecast — daytime max ~27°C (81°F), evening min ~16°C (61°F); **57–78% rain probability at night**, cloudy with possible thunderstorms (Conagua). Humidity ~73%, light southerly wind.

Score adjustment: SLIGHT DOWN total goals — wet surface may slow passing tempo; SLIGHT UP set-piece/scramble tail risk.

Factor	Evidence	Direction	Confidence
Altitude ~1,500 m	Estadio Akron elevation	Neutral — both squads acclimated in tournament	Low
Evening rain risk	57–78% precip probability at kickoff window	DOWN total goals slightly	Medium
Elfath style	NED 2-2 — composed, few controversies	NO CHANGE	Low–Medium
Spain motivation	Win group outright; avoid knockout uncertainty	UP favorite scoring	Medium
Uruguay desperation	Must chase if trailing; missing key attackers	UP Spain counter tail OR DOWN Uruguay goals	Medium

Event Background

Group H Context (After MD2)

Team	P	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts
Spain	2	1	1	0	4	0	+4	4
Uruguay	2	0	2	0	3	3	0	2
Cape Verde	2	0	2	0	2	2	0	2
Saudi Arabia	2	0	1	1	1	5	-4	1

Tiebreak: Uruguay ahead of Cape Verde on goals scored (3 vs 2). Parallel fixture: Cape Verde vs Saudi Arabia (Houston, 8:00 PM ET same time).

Previous Results & Stakes

MD1: Spain 0–0 Cape Verde (Atlanta); Saudi Arabia 1–1 Uruguay (Miami)

MD2: Spain 4–0 Saudi Arabia (Atlanta); Uruguay 2–2 Cape Verde (Miami)

Stakes: Only Group H match outside the USA — winner of Group H meets Group J runner-up (LA, Jul 2); runner-up meets Group J winner (Miami, Jul 3). Spain secure top spot with draw; Uruguay need point minimum, win preferred to avoid third-place lottery.

H2H (Verified): 1950 WC Final Round 2-2; 1990 WC group 0-0; 2013 Confederations Cup Spain 2-1. Spain unbeaten in last meeting.

Team Overview

Uruguay

Two-time World Cup champions under **Marcelo Bielsa**, whose high-octane press defines La Celeste. Squad built around **Federico Valverde** (€90M), but missing **Ronald Araujo** (calf) and **Giorgian de Arrascaeta** (calf) — Bielsa confirmed Jun 22: "They have no chance of playing against Spain." **José María Giménez** expected to return to XI.

Style: 4-3-3 high press, vertical transitions via Valverde/Canobbio. **Tournament form:** D 1-1, D 2-2. **Risk:** Bentancur & Olivera on yellow-card warning.

Spain

UEFA EURO 2024 winners under **Luis de la Fuente**. Reigning European champions with generational wide talent — **Lamine Yamal, Nico Williams, Mikel Oyarzabal** (2 goals vs Saudi Arabia). **Pedri suspended** after yellows vs Cape Verde and Saudi Arabia.

Style: 4-3-3 possession control; Rodri anchor, Olmo/Ruiz advanced. **Tournament form:** D 0-0, W 4-0. **Strength:** 0 goals conceded, +4 GD.

Category	Uruguay	Spain
FIFA Ranking (pre-tournament)	#16 (Jun 2026)	#2 (Jun 2026)
Live FIFA Ranking (Jun 20)	#18	#3
Squad Value (Transfermarkt)	~\$340M	~\$1.35B
World Cup Titles	2 (1930, 1950)	1 (2010)
Opta Win Probability	15.8%	62.2%
Tournament xG Diff (SI)	+1.37 (6th in tourney)	+2.41

Predicted Starters & Tactics

Assumed/Inference Lineups projected from Al Jazeera, Sports Mole, RotoWire (Jun 24–26).

Pedri OUT (suspension); Araujo & De Arrascaeta OUT (injury). Confirm ~1 hour before kickoff.

Estadio Akron · ~61°F evening · 57–78% rain risk · ~1,500 m

Uruguay 4-3-3 vs Spain 4-3-3



Key absences & subs (Assumed): OUT — Ronald Araujo, Giorgian de Arrascaeta (URU, calf); Pedri (ESP, suspension). Likely URU subs: De La Cruz, Pellistri, Viñas, Rochet. Likely

ESP subs: Baena, Merino, Zubimendi, Iglesias, Grimaldo.

Tactical Question	Watch For	Betting Implication
Can Uruguay press without Araujo?	Giménez/Cáceres vs Yamal/Williams 1v1s wide.	If Spain win wide duels early, win-to-nil and –1.5 strengthen.
Pedri absence	Olmo + Fabian Ruiz creativity vs Ugarte/Bentancur press.	Spain may be slightly less fluid — favors Under 3.5 goal.
Bielsa must-win mentality	Uruguay push fullbacks high after 60' if trailing.	Late Spain counters support 2-0 correct score over 1-0.
Wet pitch at altitude	Slippery surface, slower passing.	Reduces Over 2.5 confidence; set pieces gain weight.

Full Parallel Rosters

Squad data: FIFA official announcements (May 2026). Market values: Transfermarkt EUR converted at 1 EUR = 1.08 USD (June 23, 2026). Heights/weights from federation/club profiles where available.



Uruguay

MANAGER

MB

Marcelo Bielsa

Head Coach

High-press 4-3-3 · Former Leeds, Argentina NT

FORWARDS

DN

Darwin Núñez

27 · \$21.6M

#9 · ST · 187cm/81kg · Al Hilal

FV

Federico Viñas

27 · \$4.3M

#21 · ST · 180cm/78kg · Real Oviedo

RA

Rodrigo Aguirre

31 · \$2.5M

#19 · ST · 186cm/80kg · Tigres UANL

MIDFIELDERS

FV

Federico Valverde

27 · \$97.2M

#8 · CM · 182cm/78kg · Real Madrid

MU

Manuel Ugarte

25 · \$27.0M

#5 · DM · 182cm/77kg · Man United

RB

Rodrigo Bentancur

29 · \$21.6M

#6 · DM · 187cm/78kg · Tottenham · YC warning

ND

Nicolás de la Cruz

29 · \$8.6M

#7 · CM · 167cm/68kg · Flamengo

GD

Giorgian de Arrascaeta

32 · \$15.1M

#10 · AM · 173cm/70kg · Flamengo · OUT (calf)



Spain

MANAGER

LF

Luis de la Fuente

Head Coach

EURO 2024 winner · 4-3-3 possession

FORWARDS

MC

Mikel Oyarzabal

29 · \$27.0M

#21 · ST · 181cm/79kg · Real Sociedad · 2 WC goals

LY

Lamine Yamal

18 · \$216.0M

#19 · RW · 180cm/72kg · Barcelona

FT

Ferran Torres

26 · \$54.0M

#7 · ST · 184cm/77kg · Barcelona

DI

Borja Iglesias

33 · \$3.0M

#26 · ST · 187cm/86kg · Celta Vigo

NW

Nico Williams

23 · \$43.2M

#17 · LW · 180cm/67kg · Athletic Bilbao

YP

Yeremy Pino

23 · \$32.4M

#11 · RW · 172cm/66kg · Villarreal

VM

Víctor Muñoz

23 · \$32.4M

#25 · LW · 180cm/72kg · Liverpool · Doubtful

MIDFIELDERS

RO

Rodri

30 · \$54.0M

#16 · DM · 191cm/82kg · Man City

PE

Pedri

23 · \$162.0M

AG	Agustín Canobbio 27 · \$8.6M #14 · RW · 177cm/70kg · Fluminense				#20 · CM · 174cm/60kg · Barcelona · SUSP (2 YCs)
MA	Maximiliano Araujo 26 · \$37.8M #20 · LW · 178cm/72kg · Sporting CP · 2 WC goals				Dani Olmo 28 · \$64.8M #10 · AM · 179cm/72kg · Barcelona
FP	Facundo Pellistri 24 · \$5.4M #11 · RW · 174cm/66kg · Panathinaikos				Fabián Ruiz 30 · \$32.4M #8 · CM · 188cm/76kg · PSG
BR	Brian Rodríguez 26 · \$8.6M #18 · LW · 174cm/68kg · Club América				Martín Zubimendi 27 · \$81.0M #18 · DM · 181cm/74kg · Arsenal
EM	Emiliano Martínez 26 · \$7.0M #15 · DM · 185cm/80kg · Palmeiras				Mikel Merino 30 · \$27.0M #6 · CM · 188cm/83kg · Arsenal
RZ	Rodrigo Zalazar 26 · \$32.4M #26 · AM · 178cm/72kg · Braga				Gavi 21 · \$32.4M #9 · CM · 173cm/68kg · Barcelona
JS	Juan Manuel Sanabria 26 · \$4.3M #25 · LB · 178cm/74kg · Real Salt Lake				Álex Baena 24 · \$43.2M #15 · LW · 174cm/70kg · Atlético Madrid
DEFENDERS					
RA	Ronald Araujo 27 · \$21.6M #4 · CB · 192cm/87kg · Barcelona · OUT (calf)				Pau Cubarsí 19 · \$86.4M #22 · CB · 184cm/78kg · Barcelona
JG	José María Giménez 31 · \$9.7M #2 · CB · 185cm/78kg · Atlético Madrid				Aymeric Laporte 32 · \$8.6M #14 · CB · 191cm/85kg · Al Nassr
SC	Sebastián Cáreres 26 · \$4.9M #3 · CB · 185cm/79kg · Club América				Eric García 25 · \$43.2M #4 · CB · 182cm/76kg · Barcelona
SB	Santiago Bueno 27 · \$10.8M #24 · CB · 189cm/84kg · Wolves				Marc Pubill 23 · \$37.8M #2 · CB · 190cm/84kg · Atlético Madrid
MO	Mathías Olivera 28 · \$16.2M				Marc Cucurella 27 · \$54.0M #24 · LB · 175cm/66kg · Chelsea
DEFENDERS					
RC					Alejandro Grimaldo 30 · \$21.6M

#16 · LB · 184cm/78kg · Napoli · YC
warning

Joaquín Piquerez

JP

27 · \$13.0M

#22 · LB · 183cm/77kg · Palmeiras

Matías Viña

MV

28 · \$3.8M

#17 · LB · 180cm/75kg · Flamengo

Guillermo Varela

GV

33 · \$1.1M

#13 · RB · 171cm/68kg · Flamengo

GOALKEEPERS

Fernando Muslera

FM

40 · \$756K

#1 · GK · 190cm/84kg · Estudiantes

Sergio Rochet

SR

33 · \$1.9M

#12 · GK · 186cm/82kg · Internacional

Santiago Mele

SM

28 · \$2.2M

#23 · GK · 186cm/80kg · Monterrey

#3 · LB · 171cm/67kg · Bayer Leverkusen

Pedro Porro

PP

26 · \$37.8M

#12 · RB · 173cm/69kg · Tottenham

Marcos Llorente

ML

31 · \$21.6M

#5 · RB · 184cm/74kg · Atlético Madrid

GOALKEEPERS

Unai Simón

US

29 · \$23.8M

#23 · GK · 190cm/84kg · Athletic Bilbao

David Raya

DR

30 · \$32.4M

#1 · GK · 183cm/76kg · Arsenal

Joan García

JG

25 · \$48.6M

#13 · GK · 194cm/88kg · Barcelona

Odds & Probabilities

DraftKings (Jun 22) and FanDuel (Jun 25) odds. Implied probabilities de-vigged manually. Opta model via Al Jazeera.

Uruguay +614 / +600 ~13% de-vigged win probability Draw +355 / +320 ~22–23% de-vigged draw probability Spain –194 / –210 ~64% de-vigged win probability			
Market	Line (Jun 22–25)	Source	Interpretation
Moneyline	URU +614 / Draw +355 / ESP –194	DraftKings	Clear favorite pricing; draw viable given Spain can settle for point.
Moneyline	URU +600 / Draw +320 / ESP –210	FanDuel	Consistent with DK; Spain ~65% raw implied.
Total Goals	2.5 — Over –108 / Under +104	DraftKings	Slight Over lean; Spain attack vs cautious Uruguay.
Asian Handicap	Spain –1.5 @ +175	RotoWire	Requires 2+ goal margin — higher variance.
Uruguay Team Total	Under 0.5 @ +102	RotoWire	Clean sheet path priced near even money.
BTTS	Not verified at all books	—	Inference: No favored given Spain defensive record.
Correct Score	Spain 2-0 ~+450	Assumed market	Aligns with central thesis.
Opta Model	ESP 62.2% / Draw 22.1% / URU 15.8%	Al Jazeera	Third-party model confirms market lean.

Quick Guide: American **–194** means wager \$194 to win \$100. **+614** means \$100 wins \$614. **Win to Nil** wins if Spain win and Uruguay score 0. **Asian Handicap –1.5** wins if

Spain win by 2+ goals. **Over 2.5** needs 3+ total goals. Confirm bet365 (-209 ESP) and Kalshi (66% ESP) for cross-book sentiment.

Risk Checklist

Injury & Suspension

Araujo, De Arrascaeta
OUT; Pedri SUSP. Late
fitness changes shift
thesis materially.

Weather Variance

57–78% evening rain
may suppress goals or
create defensive errors
— monitor 2 hrs pre-
kickoff.

Parallel Group H Result

Cape Verde vs Saudi
Arabia concurrent;
Uruguay may play for
draw if Cape Verde trails.

Maximum budget: \$100. Do not chase losses. Concentrated 70% on win-to-nil loses entirely on a 1-1 draw. Minors prohibited from sports wagering where applicable.

Sources

- FIFA — Uruguay vs Spain Preview
- FIFA — Spain Squad Announcement
- Reuters — Uruguay Squad (May 31, 2026)
- DraftKings Network — Opening Odds (Jun 22, 2026)
- Sports Illustrated — FanDuel Odds (Jun 25, 2026)
- RotoWire — Picks & Odds
- Al Jazeera — Prediction, Pedri Suspension, Opta
- AS USA — Group H Standings & Qualification
- OneFootball — Referee Ismail Elfath
- Telediario — Guadalajara Weather Jun 26, 2026
- Transfermarkt — Uruguay Squad Values
- Transfermarkt — Spain Squad Values
- Yahoo Sports — Bielsa Rules Out Araujo & De Arrascaeta
- ESPN — FIFA Rankings June 2026

